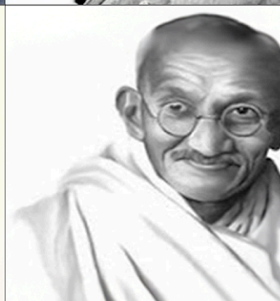


General Knowledge

Modern History

STUDY NOTES

Tribal Movements



Tribal Movements

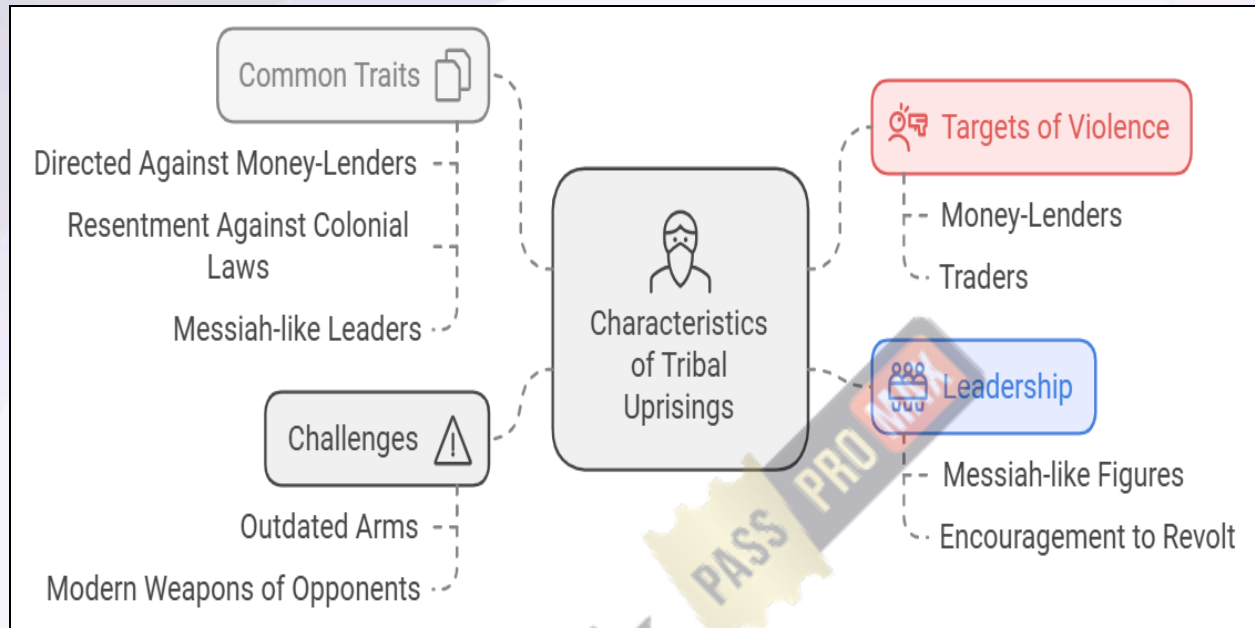


The conditions of the tribal people were not different from those of the people living in the **mainland** but the encroachment by outsiders into their independent tribal polity made them more aggrieved and violent.

Characteristics of Tribal Revolts:

- There were **some common characteristics of the tribal uprisings** even though they were separated from one another in time and space.
- The **violence was directed towards the money-lenders and traders** who were seen as extensions of the colonial government.
- **Resentment against the imposition of laws by the 'foreign government' was seen as an effort to destroy the tribals' traditional socioeconomic framework.**
- Many uprisings were led by **messiah-like figures who encouraged their people to revolt.**

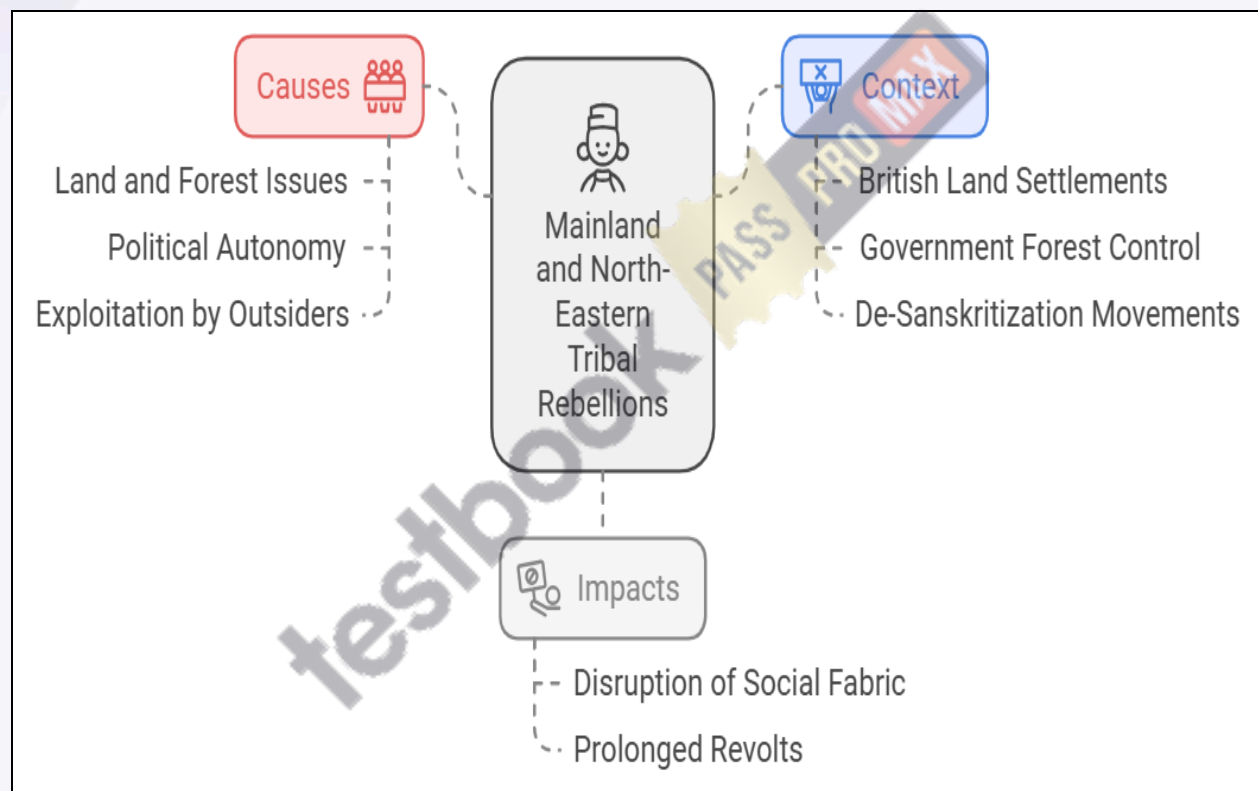
- The tribal uprisings were doomed from the beginning, given the **outdated arms** they fought with, as **against the modern weapons and techniques used by their opponents**.



Different Causes for Mainland and North-Eastern Tribal Revolts:

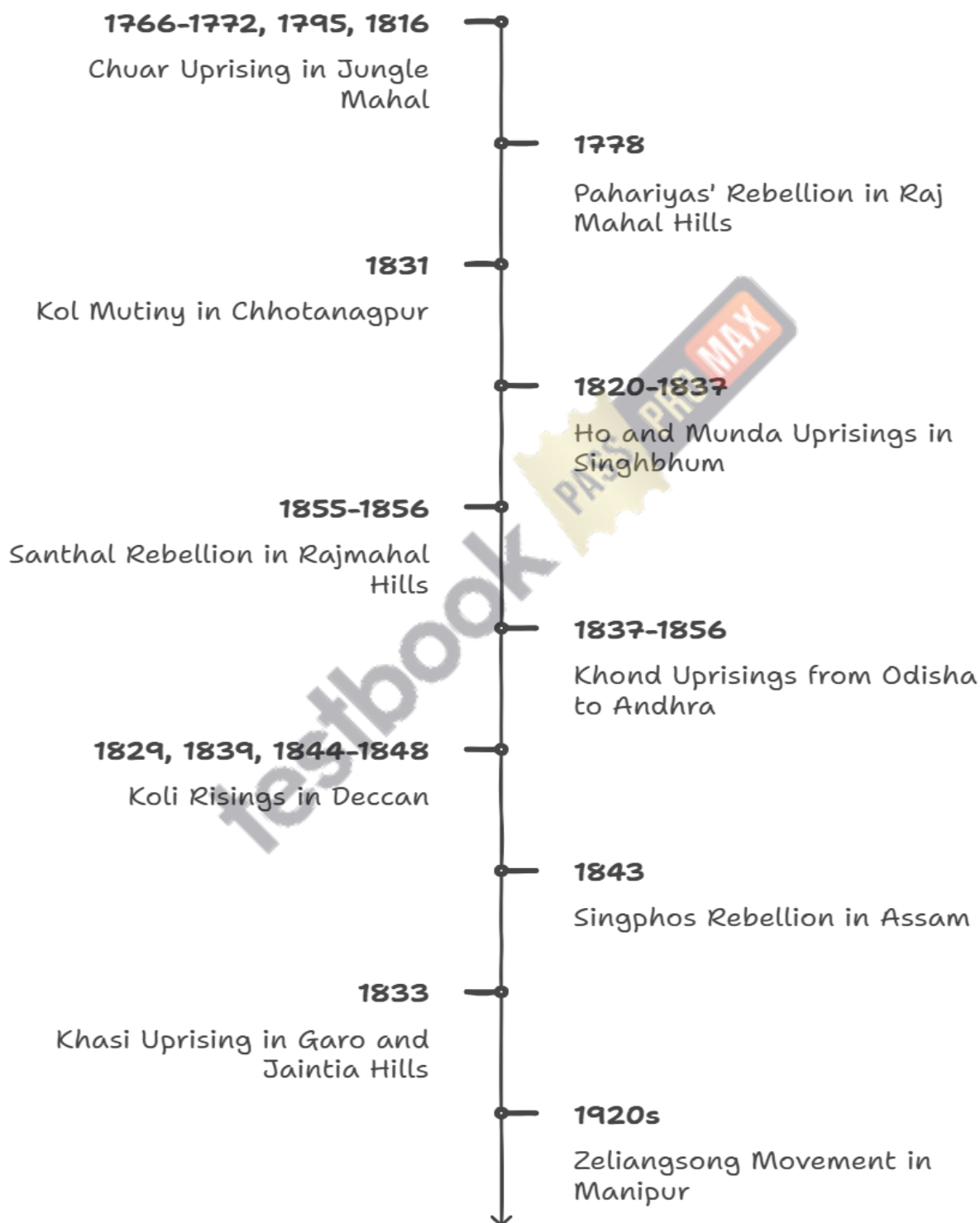
MAINLAND REGION	NORTH- EASTERN REGION
The mainland tribal rebellions were sparked off by a number of factors, an important one concerned with the tribal lands or forests.	Their revolts were often in favor of political autonomy within the Indian Union or complete independence.
The land settlements of the British affected the joint ownership tradition among the tribals and disrupted their social fabric.	These movements were not forest-based or agrarian revolts as these tribals were generally in control of land and forest area.

The government further extended its control over the forest areas by setting up reserved forests and restricting timber use and grazing.	De-Sanskritization movements also spread among the frontier tribals.
Exploitation by the police, traders, and money-lenders (most of them 'outsiders') aggravated the tribals' sufferings.	The frontier tribal revolts under the British continued for a longer time than the non-frontier tribal movements.



Important Tribal Movements of Mainland:

Key Tribal Movements Against Colonial Rule



NAME	REGION	LEADER/ TRIBE	CAUSES	OUTCOME
Pahariyas' Rebellion 1778	Raj Mahal Hills		The British expansion on their territory led to an uprising by the martial Pahariyas of the Raj Mahal Hills in 1778.	The British were forced to usher in peace by declaring their territory as damni-kol area.
Chuar Uprising 1766 to 1772 and 1795 and 1816 or Revolt of the Jungle Mahal	Jungle Mahal of Midnapore and Bankura district (in Bengal)	Jagannath Singh Shyam Ganjan of Dhadka, Subla Singh of Kaliapal and Dubraj, Durjan (or Durjol) Singh	Famine, enhanced land revenue demands, and economic distress	The revolt was brutally suppressed by the British.
Kol Mutiny (1831)	Chhotanagpur (Ranchi, Singhbhum, Hazaribagh, Palamau and the western parts of Manbhum)	Buddho Bhagat	The trouble in 1831 started with large-scale transfers of land from Kol headmen to outsiders like Hindu, Sikh, and Muslim farmers and money	The Kol rebels killed or burnt about a thousand outsiders. Only after large-scale military operations could order be restored.

			lenders who were oppressive and demanded heavy taxes.	
Ho and Munda Uprisings (1820-1837)	Singhbhum (now in Jharkhand).	Raja of Parashat and Birsa Munda.	Against the newly introduced farming revenue policy and the entry of Bengalis into their region.	British armed forces were then deployed. Birsa was captured and imprisoned.
The Santhal Rebellion (1855-56)	Rajmahal hills (Bihar)	Sidhu and Kanhu	The money-lenders who had the support of the police among others had joined the zamindars to subject the peasants to oppressive exactions and dispossession of lands.	The rebellion was suppressed by 1856.
Khond Uprisings (1837-1856)	From Odisha to the Srikakulam and Visakhapatnam districts	Chakra Bisoi	To oppose the suppression of human sacrifice, new taxes, and the	With Chakra Bisoi's disappearance, the The uprising

	of Andhra Pradesh		entry of zamindars into their areas.	came to an end.
Koya Revolts (1803, 1840, 1845, 1858, 1861, and 1862)	Eastern Godavari track (modern Andhra)	Tomma Sora and Khonda Sara chiefs	Their complaints were oppression by police and moneylenders, new regulations, and denial of their customary rights over forest areas.	After the death of Tomma Sora, another rebellion was organized in 1886 by Raja Anantayyar.
Bhil Revolts 1817-19	Western Ghats (Deccan region)		Famine, economic distress, and misgovernment.	The British used both force and conciliatory efforts to control the uprising.
Koli Risings (1829, 1839, and again during 1844-48)	(Deccan region)		They resented the imposition of the Company's rule which brought with it large-scale unemployment for them and the dismantling of their forts	British used both force and conciliatory efforts to control the uprising.

Ramosi Risings	Hill tribes of the Western Ghats	Chittur Singh, Umaji Naik, Bapu Trimbakji Sawant	After the annexation of the Maratha territories by the British, the Ramosis , who had been employed by the Maratha. The administration lost its means of livelihood.	Superior British force restored order in the area. Generally, the British followed a pacifist policy towards the Ramosis , and even recruited some of them into the hill police.

Tribal Movements of the North-East:

Khasi Uprising 1833	Garo and Jaintia Hills (now Meghalaya)	Tirath Singh	East India Company wanted to build a road linking the Brahmaputra Valley with Sylhet . For this, a large number of outsiders including Englishmen, Bengalis, and the laborers from	By 1833, the superior English The military force had suppressed the revolt
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			the plains were brought to these regions.	
Zeliangsong Movement (the 1920s)	Manipur	Led by Zemi, Liangmei and Rongmei tribes	Against the failure of the British to protect them during the Kuki violence in 1917-19.	
Singphos Rebellion (1843)	Assam	Chief Nirang Phidu led an uprising		